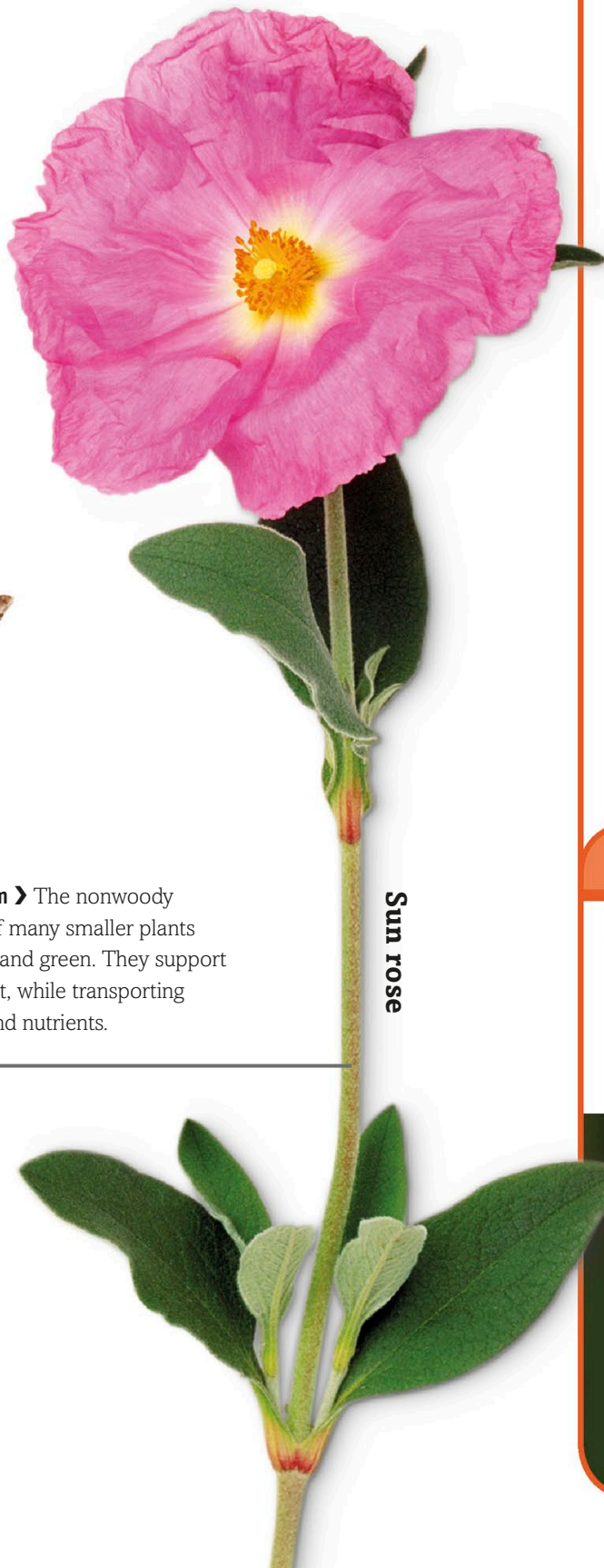




Corkscrew
hazel

Woody stem ➤ Trunks and branches are woody stems, which are stiff and strong to provide support for tall trees. The live tissue (cambium) is protected by an outer covering of dead bark. These stems expand by producing new layers of woody tissue each year—the growth rings that can be seen in cut tree trunks.

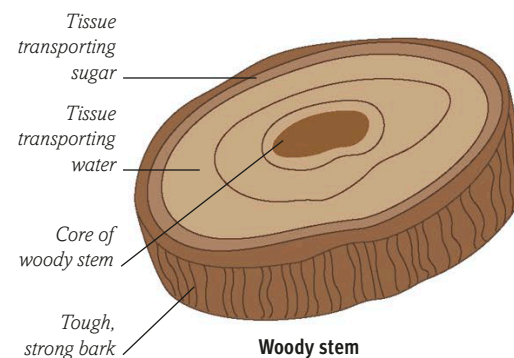
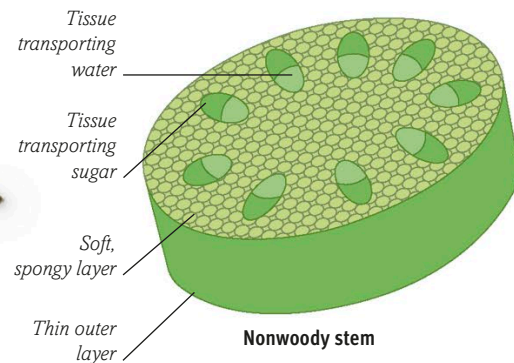


Sun rose

Soft stem ➤ The nonwoody stems of many smaller plants are soft and green. They support the plant, while transporting water and nutrients.

Types of stems

There are many types of stem. Woody stems contain two layers of tissue—one transports water, and the other food in the form of sugar. In nonwoody stems, these tissues are combined into tubes. Woody stems are protected by thickened bark, while nonwoody stems are covered by a thin, protective tissue layer.



Sweet sap suckers

Small bugs called aphids puncture stems to suck out the sweet, nutrient-rich liquid transported inside it. These insects don't usually kill the plant but can often slow down its growth and carry diseases that might harm it.

